

Rep. Tom Emmer on Sunday Morning Futures

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CHERYL:

11th staving off a potential government shutdown until after the midterms. Let's bring in now with more House Majority Whip Minnesota Congressman Tom Emmer. Congressman it's always great to speak with you. Let's first talk about the agenda. What is at the top of the agenda? Obviously short-term government funding. You want to avert any kind of pre-election shutdown. But what else are you watching? You've only got 16 legislative days before you leave again on October 1st. What can you get done?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well Cheryl great to be with you this morning. First off you hit the number one thing. The short-term funding bill that was sent over by the Senate. The continuing resolution that would fund the government through December 11th. That'll be a priority over in the House because we get things done Cheryl. That's the whole issue. You're asking what our priorities are. We've sent our priorities over to the Senate. We sent the Clarity Act which is about digital assets. A market structure bill. We sent that a year ago Cheryl with almost 100 Democrat votes and it languishes over in the Senate. We sent the Save America Act several times and it sits over there languishing in the Senate. And we sent over obviously Reconciliation 3.0 which is also just sitting there in the Senate. It really is going to be on the Senate's shoulders to start getting something done when we get back. As for the House we've got appropriations bills. Many of our members have different priorities. Those will be addressed. There's a surface transportation bill that needs to be addressed by the 30th. Obviously these would all be covered by the CR but these are the priorities of the House and the House has been working Cheryl. We've been getting our stuff over to the Senate. The Senate's got to start to perform.

CHERYL:

Now what are you hearing from the other side however and I mean the Senate side the Republican side because you know it's still unclear if Senate Majority Leader John Thune has the votes for Save America. The Clarity Act is still a hanging question mark right now. What do you know? What can you share with us?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well look what's coming out of the Senate everybody has heard them say we don't have the votes. Really? You don't have the votes for something that's an 80% issue across this country with Republicans, Democrats and others. People believe it's reasonable that in order to vote in this country you must first establish that you are a lawful citizen. That's number one. Number two when you show up to vote you make sure that you identify you can confirm that you are that citizen who is lawfully right to vote by showing a photo ID. That's an 80% issue. That is something that is Republican, Democrat and other and they tell us they don't have the votes. Here's the other thing that you got to pay attention to when you say you don't have the votes tell us what the problem is. What exactly do you disagree with when it comes to the American people and they're not telling us that. So as a House member I am extremely frustrated but it is not me that you should be concerned about. It's the American people who want this done.

CHERYL:

Yeah no and certainly the American people are looking at a headline that's a little disconcerting and that's the nation's debt. We surpassed 40 trillion dollars. So in any way shape or form is fiscal restraint going to be on the agenda for you and your colleagues?

REP. TOM EMMER:

It has been. You understand this didn't happen overnight. Cheryl this has been going on for decades and it's been an irresponsible handling of the funds I would argue for decades and that the President Donald Trump and House Republicans are absolutely committed as I believe our Senate colleagues are too to reducing that debt and the deficit and I think that will be priority number one once we get through these midterms. We already had a record amount that we cut. Unfortunately it's like spit on a hot tar road in the middle of July Cheryl. There's so much that we have yet to do. There's only one party by the way that's going to and that is Donald J Trump and Republicans in the House and the Senate are the only ones that are going to make sure that this great republic continues for the benefit of our children and grandchildren and generations to come.

CHERYL:

Well then let me ask you about the messaging to the American people because we saw consumer confidence fall in August. Americans are worried about gasoline prices, what they're seeing at the grocery store, health care prices. You know so what is the messaging plan here for Republicans as you go into the midterms because this seems to be issue number one for America and that's affordability. How do you get that message out there from your side?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well it's very interesting Cheryl. I talk to our members all across this country. They talk about the great things that are in that working families tax cut, the big beautiful bill, whatever you want to call it and they're pulling out those different items that really we have to do a good job messaging at the street level. At the macro level what do you expect the public to feel when the left-wing media is writing articles on a regular basis and telling the American people it's not good out there. It is. Wages are rising faster than they have risen in decades and they are keeping up. The feeling though based on all of the information they're getting is well it's not it's not that great. Really their spending is up. Their spending is up. Their wages are up. I think we've got to do a really good job down the stretch of emphasizing that and I think the American people they recognize they're smarter than Washington and these left-wing media types. They understand this is an election about common sense which is Donald Trump and Republicans and crazy insanity which is our colleagues on the other side of the aisle.

CHERYL:

Yeah we were talking about that with Senator Moody a moment ago but real quick before you go, you know a big component of this is President Trump. He's not on the ticket in November but his voice, his image, his work that he's doing matters. You got to get the base out there in November. You've got to motivate people to go to the polls. How do you do that and also you know MAGA Inc, that super PAC is sitting on about 400 million dollars. You know is that going to get deployed ahead of the midterms?

REP. TOM EMMER:

You know it's funny there was a a survey Harris X survey that was published in Newsweek which isn't exactly a right-leaning publication back in July. It was about voter enthusiasm and they broke it out Cheryl with MAGA Republicans, Republicans, Democrats, Independents. I don't know why they decided not to break out

Democrats into anarchists, Marxists, Communists. They just called them Democrats. What was interesting from this survey is that it showed that MAGA Republicans, more than 80 percent of them plan on voting in the midterm. Cheryl, we've been told time and time again without Donald J Trump on the ballot these people are not coming out. We've got a president who is totally invested. He didn't run for two years. He ran for four. He understands the gravity of this midterm. He understands that we're swimming upstream based on history but we have the best map we've ever had. We've got a performance in terms of the economic wins. Billions of dollars are coming into our economy right now and people on the street are starting to feel it. That's going to be the key is that hits November 3rd. I believe we're going to be in great shape when we get there and Donald Trump and MAGA Inc. I think they're going to start spending that 400 million especially in house races and you saw Elon Musk is committed spending I think another 100 million. I like our odds going into November, Cheryl.

CHERYL:

All right. House Majority Whip Congressman Tom Emmer, it's always great to speak with you. Thanks for joining me this morning, sir. All right, we've got a lot more coming up today. The fight over California's economic future.

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